“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 7

The Meeting with Vallabha Bhaṭṭa

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I worship those who sip the honey of Śrī Caitanya’s lotus feet: by their mercy alone even a wretched soul becomes immortal.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 The next year all the devotees of Gauḍa came, and Mahāprabhu met them all as before.

4 While the Lord was thus enjoying His pastimes with the devotees, Vallabha Bhaṭṭa came to meet Him.

5 Coming before the Lord, the Bhaṭṭa bowed at His feet, and the Lord embraced him, regarding him as a *bhāgavata*, a devotee.

6 Showing him honour, the Lord seated him near Himself, and the Bhaṭṭa humbly began to speak.

7 “For many days I have longed to see You. Jagannātha has fulfilled my desire: I have seen You.

8 Whoever obtains Your sight is fortunate. When I see You, it is as if I see Bhagavān Himself.

9 Whoever remembers You becomes pure. What wonder, then, that one becomes pure by seeing You?

10 'When people merely remember such saints, their very homes become pure at once. How much more, then, when they see them and touch them, wash their feet and offer them a seat!' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.19.33)[3]

11 The dharma of the age of Kali is the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name. Without Kṛṣṇa's power no one can propagate it.[4]

12 You have propagated it — that is the proof. You bear Kṛṣṇa's power; of this there is no doubt.

13 You have made Kṛṣṇa's name manifest in the world. Whoever sees You floats in love for Kṛṣṇa.

14 Without Kṛṣṇa's power prema is not manifested. Kṛṣṇa alone is the giver of prema — so the scriptures testify.

15 'Let there be many all-auspicious avatāras of the Lord whose navel is a lotus; but who other than Kṛṣṇa gives prema even to the creepers?'" (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 1.5.37)[5]

16 Mahāprabhu said, "Listen, wise Bhaṭṭa. I am a Māyāvādī sannyāsī; I do not know devotion to Kṛṣṇa.[6]

17 Advaitācārya Gosāñi is Īśvara Himself, and in His company My mind became pure.

18 In all the scriptures and in devotion to Kṛṣṇa He has no equal; therefore His name is Advaita Ācārya, the peerless teacher.

19 By His mercy even mlecchas gain devotion to Kṛṣṇa. Who can describe the power of His Vaiṣṇava nature?

20 Nityānanda Avadhūta is Īśvara Himself. Intoxicated with the madness of ecstatic emotion (*bhāva*), He is an ocean of love for Kṛṣṇa.

21 Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya knows the six systems of philosophy (*darśanas*). In these six systems he is the guru of the world, and he is the best of bhāgavatas.

22 He showed Me the farthest limit of bhakti-yoga; by his grace I came to know that the yoga of devotion to Kṛṣṇa is the essence.

23 Rāmānanda Rāya is a treasury of the rasa of Kṛṣṇa. He made Me understand that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself.

24 Through him I came to know that prema-bhakti is the crown jewel of the goals of life (*puruṣārthas*), and that prema-bhakti on the path of spontaneous attraction (*rāga*) is the highest of all.[7]

25 Servitude, friendship, parental love and the love of the beloved (*śṛṅgāra*) — of these the servant, the friend, the elder and the beloved are the shelter (*āśraya*).

26 There is *bhāva* joined with the knowledge of majesty, and there is pure (*kevala*) *bhāva*. By the knowledge of majesty one does not attain the son of the king of Vraja.[8]

27 ‘This Bhagavān, the son of the gopī, is not so easily attained by the embodied, nor by the jñānīs, nor by those who have realised the self, as He is

by those who have devotion.' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.9.21)[9]

28 The word *ātma-bhūta* means His associates. Because of her knowledge of His majesty, Lakṣmī did not attain the son of the king of Vraja.[10]

29 'At the festival of the rāsa dance He embraced the beautiful women of Vraja around their necks with His arms, and they attained their heart's desire. Such favour was not granted even to Śrī, who is wholly devoted to Him, nor to the celestial women, fragrant and radiant like lotuses — what then of others?' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.47.60)[11]

30 In pure *bhāva* His friend climbs on His shoulders, and in pure *bhāva* the queen of Vraja binds Him.[12]

31 'My friend,' 'my son' — such is the pure mind. Therefore Śuka and Vyāsa praise it.

32 'Thus the cowherd boys, who had amassed heaps of pious deeds, played with Him who is to the sages the experience of Brahman's bliss, to those who have taken up His service the Supreme Deity, and to those under the spell of māyā a human child.' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.12.11)[13]

33 'She looked upon Hari, whose glory is sung by the three Vedas, the Upaniṣads, the works on Sāṅkhya and yoga and the Sātvata scriptures, as her own son.' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.8.45)[14]

34 'O brāhmaṇa, what good deed did Nanda perform to win such great fortune? And what did the most fortunate Yaśodā do, that Hari Himself drank from her breast?' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.8.46)[15]

35 Even when he sees Kṛṣṇa's majesty, one whose *bhāva* is pure has no awareness of it. Therefore pure *bhāva* is superior to the mood of majesty.

36 All this Rāya Rāmānanda taught Me, and to hear it is supreme bliss.[16]

37 Rāmānanda's power cannot be described. By Rāya's grace I came to know the pure *bhāva* of Vraja.

38 Dāmodara Svarūpa is the rasa of prema embodied. In his company I came to know the sweet rasa (*madhura-rasa*) of Vraja.

39 The pure prema of the goddesses of Vraja is without even a trace of lust (*kāma*). Its sign is this: its only aim is Kṛṣṇa's happiness.

40 'O dear one, Your tender lotus feet we place gently on our hard breasts, afraid to hurt them — and with those feet You wander through the forest! Are they not hurt by the sharp pebbles? You are our very life, and our minds are reeling.' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.19)[17]

41 'Disregarding husbands, sons, kin, brothers and relatives, we have come to Your side, O Acyuta, enchanted by Your song. You know why we have come. O cheat, who would abandon women at night?' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.16)[18]

42 This worship is the highest of all, surpassing every form of bhakti. Therefore Kṛṣṇa says, 'I am your debtor.'

43 'O gopīs, your union with Me is faultless. Even in a lifetime of the gods I could not repay you for what you have done: you cut the fetters of home, so hard to break, and came to Me. So let your own good deed be your reward.' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.22)[19]

44 Pure *bhāva* is superior to the knowledge of majesty. On earth there is no devotee equal to Uddhava,

45 yet he prays for the dust of their feet. All this I learned in the company of Svarūpa.[20]

46 Haridāsa Ṭhākura is the foremost of the great bhāgavatas. Every day he chants three lakhs (three hundred thousand) of names.

47 From him I learned the glory of the holy name; by his grace that glory was revealed to Me.

48 Ācāryaratna, Ācāryanidhi, Gadādhara Paṇḍita, Jagadānanda, Dāmodara, Śaṅkara, Vakreśvara,

49 Kāśīśvara, Mukunda, Vāsudeva, Murāri and all the other devotees who descended in Gauḍa

50 have preached the name of Kṛṣṇa and prema throughout the world, and whatever devotion to Kṛṣṇa I have, I have gained in their company."[21]

51 Mahāprabhu knew how firmly pride was rooted in the Bhaṭṭa's heart, and so He spoke all this by way of a hint.[22]

52 'I am a Vaiṣṇava,' the Bhaṭṭa thought. 'I know all the conclusions of bhakti, and no one explains the meaning of the Bhāgavata better than I.'

53 Such was the pride that had long lived in his mind, but the Lord's words humbled it.[23]

54 Hearing from the Lord's own mouth about the Vaiṣṇava qualities of all these devotees, the Bhaṭṭa wished to see them all.

55 The Bhaṭṭa said, "Where do all these Vaiṣṇavas live? How can I see them?"

56 The Lord said, “Some live in Gauḍa, some in other lands, but all have come to see the Ratha-yātrā.

57 They are all staying here, in lodgings in various places. Here you will be able to see them all.”

58 Then the Bhaṭṭa spoke many humble words and earnestly invited the Lord to a meal.[24]

59 The next day all the Vaiṣṇavas came to the Lord, and Mahāprabhu introduced the Bhaṭṭa to them all.

60 Seeing the radiance of the Vaiṣṇavas, the Bhaṭṭa was amazed: before them all he was like a firefly.

61 Then the Bhaṭṭa had a great quantity of mahā-prasāda brought and fed Mahāprabhu and His associates.

62 The sannyāsīs, with Paramānanda Purī, all sat on one side to eat.

63 Mahāprabhu sat in the middle, with Advaita and Nityānanda Rāya on either side, and the devotees in front and behind.

64 I cannot tell how many devotees from Gauḍa there were; they all sat in rows in the courtyard.

65 Seeing the Lord’s devotees, the Bhaṭṭa was amazed, and in the Lord’s presence he bowed at the feet of them all.[25]

66 Svarūpa, Jagadānanda, Kāśīśvara and Śaṅkara served the food, and so did Rāghava and Dāmodara.

67 Vallabha Bhaṭṭa had brought a great deal of mahā-prasāda, and the sannyāsīs sat down with the Lord to eat.

68 The Vaiṣṇavas honoured the prasāda, saying “Hari! Hari!”, and the sound of “Hari” rose and filled the whole universe.

69 The Bhaṭṭa brought plenty of garlands, sandal paste, areca nuts and betel leaves, and when he had honoured everyone with them, he was filled with joy.

70 On the day of the Ratha-yātrā the Lord began the kīrtana. As before, He formed seven separate groups.

71 Advaita, Nityānanda, Haridāsa, Vakreśvara, Śrīvāsa, Rāghava and Gadādhara Paṇḍita —

72 these seven led the kīrtana in seven places, and the Lord moved from group to group, calling “Hari bol!”[26]

73 Fourteen *mādalas* (drums) sounded in the loud saṅkīrtana, and the world floated in the prema of each of the dancers.[27]

74 Seeing this, Vallabha Bhaṭṭa was amazed. Overwhelmed with bliss, he lost all composure.

75 Then Mahāprabhu stopped everyone’s dancing, and the Bhaṭṭa was amazed at the Lord’s conduct.

76 At another festival the Bhaṭṭa went to Mahāprabhu and submitted a request at His feet:[28]

77 “I have written something of a commentary on the Bhāgavata. Would You, Mahāprabhu, hear it Yourself?”

78 The Lord said, “I cannot understand the meaning of the Bhāgavata. I am not qualified even to hear its meaning.[29]

79 I simply sit and chant Kṛṣṇa’s name, and even so, night and day, I cannot complete My fixed number of names.”

80 The Bhaṭṭa said, “I have explained the meaning of Kṛṣṇa’s name at length. Please hear it.”

81 The Lord said, “I do not accept many meanings of Kṛṣṇa’s name. I know only this: Śyāmasundara, the dark and beautiful One, and Yaśodā-nandana, the son of Yaśodā.

82 ‘The conventional meaning (*rūḍhi*) of the name “Kṛṣṇa” is He whose lustre is dark like a *tamāla* tree and who drinks at the breast of Śrī Yaśodā: this is the conclusion of all the scriptures.’ (Nāma-kaumudī)[30]

83 This meaning alone I know as settled; I have no qualification for any other meanings.”

84 The Bhaṭṭa’s explanations of the name and the rest were all nearly worthless (*phalgu*). Knowing this, the all-knowing Lord disregarded them.

85 Dejected, the Bhaṭṭa went home, and his devotion to the Lord partly ebbed away.[31]

86 Then the Bhaṭṭa went to Paṇḍita Gosāñi. Showing friendship in many ways, he kept coming and going.[32]

87 Because the Lord disregarded him, none of the people of Nīlācala would listen to the Bhaṭṭa's explanations.

88 The Bhaṭṭa felt ashamed and dishonoured, and in his grief he went to the Paṇḍita.

89 Humbly he said, "I have taken shelter of you. Be merciful and save my life.

90 If you will hear my explanation of Kṛṣṇa's name, the mire of my shame will be washed away."

91 The Paṇḍita was caught in a dilemma and full of doubt: he could not decide what he should do.[33]

92 Although the Paṇḍita did not consent, the Bhaṭṭa came and read to him anyway, forcing it on him.

93 The Bhaṭṭa was a man of noble standing (*ābhijātya*), and so the Paṇḍita could not stop him. "Kṛṣṇa, protect me in this plight," he prayed. "I have taken shelter of You.[34]

94 The Lord dwells in the heart; He will know my mind, and I have no fear of Him. But His associates are 'severe'."[35]

95 Although, rightly judged, the Paṇḍita was not at fault, the Lord's associates still showed him an anger born of love (*praṇaya-roṣa*).

96 Every day Vallabha Bhaṭṭa came to the Lord and picked arguments with the Ācārya and others.

97 Whatever ‘conclusion’ (*siddhānta*) the Bhaṭṭa tried to establish, the Ācārya refuted the moment he heard it.

98 Whenever the Bhaṭṭa came before the Ācārya and the others, he was like a heron among royal swans.

99 One day the Bhaṭṭa asked the Ācārya: “The jīva is *prakṛti*, the female, and accepts Kṛṣṇa as her husband (*pati*).

100 A wife devoted to her husband does not utter her husband’s name. Yet you utter Kṛṣṇa’s name — what sort of dharma is that?”

101 The Ācārya said, “Before you stands dharma embodied. Ask Him; He will resolve the question.”

102 The Lord said, “You do not know what is dharma and what is adharma. A faithful wife’s dharma is to follow her husband’s order.[36]

103 The husband’s order is to utter his name ceaselessly, and a faithful wife cannot transgress her husband’s order.

104 Therefore she utters the name and gains the fruit of the name: by that fruit love (prema) for Kṛṣṇa’s feet awakens.”

105 Hearing this, Vallabha Bhaṭṭa fell silent. He went home and brooded sorrowfully:

106 “Every day I am defeated in this assembly. If only my word would prevail just once,

107 I would be happy, and all my shame would be gone. What means can I find to establish my own view?”

108 The next day he came, bowed to the Lord, and sat down. Then, proud at heart, he spoke in the assembly:

109 "In the *Bhāgavata* I have refuted Śrīdhara Svāmī's explanations. I cannot accept the words of his commentary.

110 He explains whatever passage he takes up just as it stands there; there is no consistency in it. Therefore I do not accept Svāmī."[37]

111 The Lord smiled and said, "Anyone who does not accept the *svāmī* — the husband — I count among prostitutes."[38]

112 Having said this, Mahāprabhu fell silent. Hearing it, everyone was satisfied at heart.

113 Gaura descended for the good of the world, and He knew the pride hidden in the Bhaṭṭa's heart.

114 By various kinds of disregard Bhagavān purified the Bhaṭṭa, just as Kṛṣṇa broke the pride of Indra.

115 An ignorant jīva takes his own good for harm. When his pride has been crushed, his eyes open at last.

116 Back at home that night, the Bhaṭṭa began to think: "Earlier, in Prayāga, the Lord showed me great mercy.

117 With His associates He accepted my invitation. Why is the Lord's mind now so changed towards me?

118 He wants my mind to be free of the pride that says 'I shall win': it is the Lord's nature to do good to all.

119 To make a name for myself, I give way to pride; to break that pride, He dishonours me.[39]

120 He is doing me good, yet I take it as sorrow — just as Indra, that great fool, behaved towards Kṛṣṇa."[40]

121 Thinking this, he came to the Lord in the morning and, humbly offering praise, took shelter at His feet.

122 "I am an ignorant jīva, and I acted as the ignorant act. Fool that I am, I displayed my learning before You.

123 You are the Lord, and You showed mercy befitting Yourself: by dishonouring me, You broke all my pride.

124 I am ignorant: in place of good I saw dishonour, just as Indra blasphemed Kṛṣṇa in ignorance.

125 By the salve of Your mercy the blindness of my pride is gone. You have shown me such mercy that now true knowledge has come.

126 I have committed offences; forgive me. I have taken shelter of You. Be merciful and place Your feet on my head."

127 The Lord said, "You are a paṇḍita and a great devotee (*mahā-bhāgavata*). Where these two qualities are found, there can be no mountain of pride.

128 Yet you blaspheme Śrīdhara Svāmī and write your own commentary! You do not accept Śrīdhara Svāmī — such is the pride you hold!

129 By the grace of Śrīdhara Svāmī I understand the *Bhāgavata*. I accept Śrīdhara Svāmī, the guru of the world, as My guru.

130 Whatever anyone writes out of pride, setting himself above Śrīdhara, will be distorted in meaning (*artha-vyasta*), and people will not accept it.

131 But what is written in the footsteps of Śrīdhara all people will honour and accept.

132 Explain the *Bhāgavata* in the footsteps of Śrīdhara. Give up your pride and worship Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān.

133 Give up offences and perform the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa. Then you will very soon attain the feet of Kṛṣṇa."[41]

134 The Bhaṭṭa said, "If You are now pleased with me, accept my invitation once again some day."

135 The Lord descended to deliver the world; He accepted the invitation to give the Bhaṭṭa joy.

136 "May the world be blessed" — such is the Lord's mind. Even when He punishes, He does so to purify a person's heart.

137 The Bhaṭṭa invited the Lord together with His associates, and Mahāprabhu was then pleased with him.

138 Jagadānanda Paṇḍita's *bhāva* was pure and deep. Like Satyabhāmā's, his love had a contrary nature (*vāmya*).[42]

139 Again and again he had loving quarrels with the Lord, and the two of them kept squabbling with each other.[43]

140 Gadādhara Paṇḍita's *bhāva* was pure and deep, with a compliant nature (*dakṣiṇa*) like that of Rukmiṇī-devī.[44]

141 The Lord wanted to see his loving anger (*praṇaya-roṣa*), but because Gadādhara was conscious of the Lord's majesty, anger never arose in him.

142 Taking this occasion, the Lord feigned anger, and when the Paṇḍita heard of it, fear arose in his heart.[45]

143 So it was long ago: when Kṛṣṇa made fun of Rukmiṇī, fear arose in her mind as she heard Him.

144 Vallabha Bhaṭṭa worshipped in the mood of parental love (*vātsalya*); he served with the Bāla-gopāla mantra.

145 In the company of the Paṇḍita his heart changed, and he gave his mind to the worship of Kiśora-gopāla.[46]

146 He wanted to receive the mantra and so on from the Paṇḍita, but the Paṇḍita said, "This is not for me to do.

147 I am dependent; my Lord is Gauracandra. Without His order I am not free to act on my own.

148 Just because you come to me, the Lord reproaches me."

149 In this way some days passed for the Bhaṭṭa. At last the Lord became fully pleased with him.

150 On the day of the invitation the Lord called for the Paṇḍita, sending Svarūpa, Jagadānanda and Govinda to bring him.

151 On the way Svarūpa said to the Paṇḍita, "The Lord disregarded you to test you.

152 Why didn't you come and reproach Him? Why did you put up with it, as if you were afraid?"

153 The Paṇḍita said, "The Lord is the crown jewel of the all-knowing. I do not think it right to be obstinate with Him.

154 Whatever He says, I bear it, holding it on my head. He Himself will weigh my merits and faults and show me mercy."

155 Saying this, the Paṇḍita came to the Lord and, weeping, fell at His feet.

156 Smiling slightly, the Lord embraced him and spoke sweet words for all to hear:

157 "I showed you anger, but you were not moved. You said nothing in anger; you bore it all.

158 My gestures did not move your mind. By your firm, simple-hearted love you have bought Me."

159 The marks of the Paṇḍita's *bhāva* cannot be described; by them the Lord came to be named 'Gadādhara-prāṇanātha' (Lord of Gadādhara's life).

160 The Lord's favour to the Paṇḍita cannot be described. People sing of Him as 'Gadāi-Gaurāṅga'.

161 Who can understand the pastimes of Caitanya Prabhu? In one pastime the Gaṅgā flows in hundreds and hundreds of streams.

162 The Lord made known to the world the Paṇḍita's gentleness, his brahminical virtue, and the firm mark of his love.

163 Washing away the mire of pride, He purified the Bhaṭṭa, and by this He taught everyone else as well.

164 Within is grace; outwardly it looks like disregard. Whoever takes only the outer meaning is ruined.[47]

165 Who has the power to understand the hidden pastimes of Caitanya? Only one whose devotion to Gauracandra is firm understands them.

166 On another day the Paṇḍita invited the Lord, and He took His meal there together with the devotees.

167 There Vallabha Bhaṭṭa received the Lord's permission, and from the Paṇḍita he obtained all he had long prayed for.[48]

168 Thus I have told of the meeting with Vallabha Bhaṭṭa. By hearing of it, one gains the treasure of love for Gaura.[49]

169 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[50]

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: *pāmara* — a godless person, bereft of bhakti; *amara* — one who possesses a transcendental body. Heading in the edition: obeisance to the devotees of Gaura, the touchstone. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 4.2 (= Ādi 1.18, 17.2, Antya 2.2, 4.2, 6.2); translation as there. ↩
3. *Anubhāṣya*: Parīkṣit, resolved to fast until death, asked the assembled sages what the one duty of a dying man is; when Śrī Śukadeva arrived, Parīkṣit greeted him humbly with these words. "Homes" — even abodes of worldly enjoyment. ↩

4. *Anubhāṣya*: without Kṛṣṇa's direct will — the power of His mercy — no one can become an ācārya, the guru of the world, and establish the chanting of the pure name; the ācārya wholly devoted to chanting the name is a direct embodiment of Kṛṣṇa's potency. ↩
5. The same verse as Ādi 3.27; translation, transliteration and word-for-word as there (the transliteration lines follow the quarters of the verse). Heading in the edition: *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, verse 303; the words of Bilvamaṅgala. *Anubhāṣya* and *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* (on Ādi 3.27): the "creepers" (*latā*) are those who have taken shelter of Him. ↩
6. Heading in the edition: the humility of Bhagavān, and His pretence. ↩
7. *Anubhāṣya*: prema-bhakti is higher than the four goals of life (dharma, artha, kāma and mokṣa) — it is the crown jewel of the puruṣārthas; service on the path of rāgānugā is higher than the worship of Kṛṣṇa on the path of rules (*vidhi*). ↩
8. Heading in the edition: in the madhura-rasa there are two dispositions — in the cities, "mixed with majesty"; in Vraja, *kevala* (pure); the son of Yaśodā is attained only by the pure disposition of *parakīyā* proper to Vraja, not by the disposition of *svakīyā* mixed with majesty. ↩
9. The same verse as Madhya 8.226 (= 9.132, 24.82); translation as there. In this chapter the word *ātma-bhūtānām* is taken to mean "the associates" (v. 28): *Anubhāṣya* on 28 — Lakṣmī and the associates called *ātma-bhūta* are potencies non-different from Kṛṣṇa, yet Lakṣmī is full of the mood of majesty. In the edition the reference is "canto 10, chapter 9, verse 31"; in the standard numbering, 10.9.21. ↩
10. *Anubhāṣya*: Lakṣmīdevī and the associates called *ātma-bhūta* are potencies non-different from Kṛṣṇa; even so, Lakṣmī is full of the mood of majesty and therefore did not gain the right to serve Vrajendra-nandana in the madhura-rasa. Heading in the edition: the meaning of a word of the verse; Lakṣmī has no right to take part in the rāsa dance. ↩
11. The same verse as Madhya 8.80 (= 8.231, 9.121); translation as there. ↩
12. *Anubhāṣya*: "in pure *bhāva*" — not enchanted or bound by the knowledge of majesty, but ruled by pure, unmixed (*kevala*) *rati*. Heading in the edition: the friendship (*sakhya*) and parental love (*vātsalya*) of the people of Vraja are *kevala*, that is, pure *rāgātmikā* bhakti. ↩
13. The same verse as Madhya 8.75; translation as there. In the edition the reference is "canto 10, chapter 12, verse 21"; in the standard numbering, 10.12.11. ↩
14. The same verse as Madhya 19.204; translation as there. ↩

15. The same verse as Madhya 8.77; translation as there. ↩
16. *Anubhāṣya*: some manuscripts read here *anargala rasa-vettā prema-sukhānanda* — “a boundless knower of rasa, full of the bliss of prema”. Heading in the edition: the Lord declares Rāya His instructing guru (*śikṣā-guru*). ↩
17. The same verse as Ādi 4.173 (= Madhya 8.218, 18.65); translation as there. ↩
18. The same verse as Madhya 19.210; translation as there. *Anubhāṣya*: another reading has here the couplet “The pure love of the gopīs is free of the knowledge of majesty; in love they scold Him — this is its sign.” ↩
19. The same verse as Ādi 4.180 (= Madhya 8.92); translation as there. ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: another reading cites here Uddhava’s prayer (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.47.61): “Ah, if only I could be some bush, creeper or herb in Vṛndāvana that receives the dust of these gopīs’ feet!” — Uddhava, having accepted as his ideal the gopīs’ love, free of the knowledge of majesty, prays for eternal service to them. ↩
21. Heading in the edition: only in the company of a sādhu who himself follows pure bhakti and preaches it does the jīva attain devotion to Kṛṣṇa. ↩
22. Heading in the edition: to rid Vallabha of his pride, the Lord describes the qualities of devotees far worthier than he. ↩
23. Heading in the edition: by the Lord’s mercy Vallabha’s pride is crushed. *Anubhāṣya*: “long-standing pride” — a well-nourished, towering self-conceit. ↩
24. The meal took place at the Lord’s residence: the Bhaṭṭa had mahā-prasāda brought there and fed the Lord and His associates (vv. 59–67). ↩
25. Some editions read *pratyeke*, “to each one”; the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition has *pratyakṣe*, “in (the Lord’s) presence”. ↩
26. Some editions read *karena nartana*, “they dance”; the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition has *karena kīrtana*, “they lead the kīrtana”. Heading in the edition: like a whirling firebrand (*alāta-cakra*), the Lord moves from kīrtana to kīrtana. ↩
27. Fourteen *mādalas* for all seven groups — two in each (compare Madhya 13.48). ↩
28. Some editions read *yātrānantare*, “after the festival”; the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition has *yātrāntare*, “at another festival”, that is, on another day (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*). ↩
29. Heading in the edition: considering Himself unqualified, the Lord speaks humbly and in pretence; without the aim of pleasing Kṛṣṇa and His own, the meaning of the Bhāgavata cannot be grasped by worldly learning. ↩

30. Heading in the edition: the *rūḍhi* meaning of the name “Kṛṣṇa” — a verse from Śrī Lakṣmīdhara’s *Nāma-kaumudī*, cited in the *Kṛṣṇa-sandarbha*. *Anubhāṣya*: *rūḍhi* is the power of a word to convey the meaning of the whole word without depending on the meanings of root and suffix. ↩
31. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the devotion he had for the Lord partly ebbed away. Heading in the edition: the Bhaṭṭa leaves with a heavy heart; his pride is humbled, and therefore his devotion to the Lord weakens. ↩
32. *Paṇḍita Gosāñi* is Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī (*Anubhāṣya*). Heading in the edition: the Bhaṭṭa begins to court Śrī Gadādhara’s favour. ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: Mahāprabhu had disregarded Vallabha Bhaṭṭa; yet if the Paṇḍita listened to his explanation of the name, it would pain the Lord. Which side was he to protect? So the Paṇḍita was caught between two fires. ↩
34. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *ābhijātye* — because of noble standing, that is, because Vallabha Bhaṭṭa was honoured among scholars. The *Anubhāṣya* gives three reasons: out of embarrassment; because Vallabha’s learning was not wholly opposed to bhakti; for the sake of the respect customary in society. Heading in the edition: Gadādhara, who honours everyone and wishes to trouble no one, is caught between two fires and begs Kṛṣṇa for mercy. ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord knew the position the Paṇḍita was in, so he had no fear of His displeasure. What he feared was that some Vaiṣṇava might call him “Vallabha’s companion” and speak against him. ↩
36. Heading in the edition: to show Vallabha mercy and point out his eternal good, the Lord answers sharply and severely, yet truly: the jīva, by nature *prakṛti*, is enjoined by Kṛṣṇa Himself, her husband, always to utter His name. ↩
37. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Śrīdhara Svāmī explains each statement just as it stands where it occurs, and so, Vallabha says, there is no unity of meaning in him. The word ‘Svāmī’ is taken up by the Lord in the next verse. ↩
38. A play on words: *svāmī* means both Śrīdhara Svāmī and “husband, master”; the Lord answers with Vallabha’s own words (110) and continues the image of the faithful wife (99–103). Heading in the edition: the Lord upholds the commentary of Śrīdhara Svāmī, “the sole guardian of bhakti”; only Śrīdhara accepts Viṣṇu, the one Spirit, as Lord (*svāmī*), while his opponent, who mixes spirit and matter, is the one who is wayward. ↩
39. Heading in the edition: by disregard, dishonour and other dealings unpleasant to the senses, the Lord, partial to no one, frees the scholar who has turned from Him of arrogance and envy. ↩
40. Heading in the edition: wise is one who sees the Lord’s mercy in the fruits of karma that are painful at first but beneficial in the end. ↩

41. The second line is the same as Antya 3.136; translation as there. Heading in the edition: the kīrtana of Kṛṣṇa free of the ten offences to the holy name leads to Kṛṣṇa's feet. ↩
42. Heading in the edition: Jagadānanda is the avatāra of Satyabhāmā; his contrary nature (*vāmya*) and pure, deep love for Gaura. Here the *Anubhāṣya* cites from the *Bṛhad-bhāgavatāmṛta* (1.7.83) the account of how Satyabhāmā, offended, withdrew to the chamber of sulking and Kṛṣṇa ordered her to be brought. ↩
43. Heading in the edition: Jagadānanda's quarrels of love (*praṇaya-kalaha*) with the Lord. ↩
44. Heading in the edition: Gadādhara is the avatāra of Rukmiṇī; his compliant nature (*dakṣiṇa*) and pure, deep love for Gaura. *Anubhāṣya* (on 140–141): once in Dvārakā Kṛṣṇa jokingly advised Rukmiṇī to choose another husband; she was frightened and, by her compliant nature, fell at His feet. So too in Gaura's pastimes: Jagadānanda, like Satyabhāmā, is contrary and quarrels out of love, while Gadādhara, like Rukmiṇī, is timid and always follows the Lord in everything. ↩
45. Heading in the edition: on the pretext of goodwill towards Vallabha, the Lord outwardly shows feigned anger and so tests Gadādhara's love; Gadādhara is frightened. ↩
46. Heading in the edition: association with Gadādhara inclines Vallabha to worship in *madhura-rasa*. ↩
47. *Anubhāṣya*: wishing Vallabha Bhaṭṭa well, the Lord outwardly disregarded him and so cleansed him of the conceit of a scholar and a Vaiṣṇava; and since Gadādhara Paṇḍita had not rejected Vallabha altogether, for some days the Lord showed disregard to him as well. Yet Mahāprabhu was never displeased with Gadādhara, the embodiment of His own *svarūpa-śakti*, nor can He be; whoever fails to grasp the hidden meaning of this pastime and loses faith in Śrī Gadādhara's feet will surely fall. ↩
48. Heading in the edition: there Vallabha receives from Gadādhara initiation into the Kiśora-gopāla mantra in *madhura-rasa*. ↩
49. Heading in the edition: the meeting of Gadādhara and Vallabha grants love for Gaura. ↩
50. The same colophon verse as Antya 2.172; translation as there. ↩